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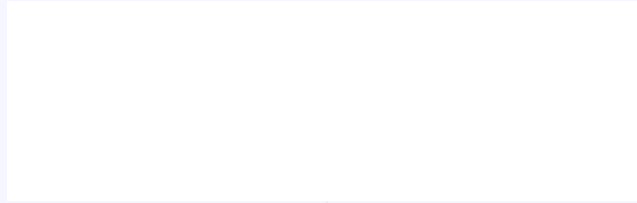
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Meet the 5th generation of Aboitiz leaders

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PETER IMBONG



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Aboitiz has made a name for more than a century. Time for a new generation to step up to the plate

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MANILA, Philippines – In the ballroom of the Marco Polo Plaza Hotel in Cebu City, Erramon Aboitiz, president and CEO of Aboitiz Equity Ventures, and grandchild of Aboitiz patriarch Don Ramon Aboitiz, stands before an audience of about a hundred student leaders from all over the country. He’s about to give his opening remarks to the Aboitiz Future Leaders Business Summit, a two-day leadership seminar created by the Cebu-based conglomerate 8 years ago.

And as the undergraduates look up to the illuminated podium onstage, at the back of the room, spread across several tables, several key members of the Aboitiz Group look on: upper management, long-time employees, and further at the back, family members working in the company.

“We look forward with much anticipation to this annual event,” he begins, “as this is where we meet promising young men and women overflowing with optimism, with an idealism that is inspiring, and a passion that is burning for what they believe in – certainly the stuff future leaders, like you, are made of.” The participants are transfixed, of course, hanging onto his every word. But if you didn’t know it, he could’ve well been addressing his relatives seated at the back.

For more than a hundred years now, the Aboitiz Group of Companies has made a name across various industries in the country. Starting as a family business trading hemp in the

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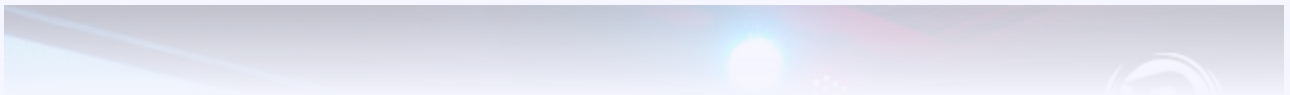
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The 57-year-old Erramon is part of the 4th generation that transformed the once family-owned business into a publicly-listed conglomerate currently with more than 20,000 employees and, as of the first half of 2013, a consolidated net income of P11.9 billion.

But as the current leaders of the company reach maturity, it'll soon be time for the 5th generation to take the reins and continue the legacy and name Don Ramon began decades ago. And for them, it's more about responsibility than honor.

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